

the most recent image, but you can select another version if you wish. Press Next to go to the confirmation screen, then press Finish. A dialog will ask for confirmation to erase the disk being restored—check the box and press OK to start the restore process.

10.4 The Control Panel

The Control Panel under Windows Vista has undergone a thorough overhaul. At first glance, the icons under the Vista Control Panel seem more than those present under XP. Thankfully, the ever-present Search box makes its presence felt in this window as well—in the upper-right hand corner, as usual. You can also search for any element of the Control Panel from the Search box in the Start Menu. This is a great feature: it means no longer having to dig through icons to find something you need to tweak or change.

When you open Control Panel, the keyboard focus is on the search box. Type “background”, or “mute” or “backup” or “resolution” or “defrag” and up come links to take you directly to the right UI to do that. You can search in your own words, without having to know the “official” name for anything. You don’t have to know what Control Panel icon to find, or what sub-page it’s on. The former is, of course, assuming you know what you’re looking for—to this end, Vista’s Control Panel offers categories and sections as tasks, rather than as tools. The interface also presents a better category view which shows links below categories—a set of options and tasks which the user has more likelihood of accessing. For example, the Windows Firewall category will show the sub-categories “Turn Firewall on or off” and “Allow a program through Windows Firewall”—both of which act as quick links to those specific tasks.

The new Control Panel also cross-references elements of Vista; for instance, Windows Firewall is under both Network and Internet, and under Security—so that you can find it no matter what you think of the Firewall as (a network or a security feature).